▶ MUKESH SAHANI

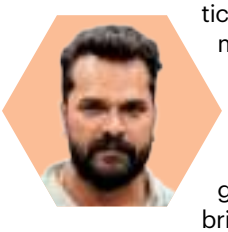
ABOARD DEPUTY CMSHIP



It's not for nothing that he has a party called VIP. Way before his alliance came around to the idea, **Mukesh Sahani** had already gone ahead and crowned himself as the incoming 'Deputy CM' in a hypothetical Mahagathbandhan (MGB) regime. That fits an old pattern, for the Vikassheel Insaan—the Expandable Man, if you like—has made a reasonable career out of amateur political dramatics. In 2020, on the eve of the previous assembly poll, he famously walked out of the MGB soon after its seat-sharing was announced—a career pivot that landed him in the NDA's camp after, as the gossip ran, a reassuring word from **Amit Shah**. Fast forward to 2025, Sahani's back in the MGB... did someone say déjà vu? His camp trumpeted a press conference on the very day Shah was in Patna. The cameras queued. But no PC. Wags have two theories: one, Sahani didn't get the go-ahead tug from his old minder, or the Congress has been whispering sweet-nothings in his ear. Anyway, unlike 2020, he's stayed put within the Grand Alliance, and is signing all correspondence as its would-be number two!

▼ STAR POWER

The Bhojpuri Spice Festival





If it feels more like the casting for a box-office double bill, that's because it's meant to be. For, what's elections without some stardust, even in dusty Bihar? If the RJD is paradropping the desi Adonis **Khesari Lal Yadav** into Chhapra, the BJP has enlisted the petite 25-year-old **Maithili Thakur** for Alinagar. To campaign? Nah! That idea morphed long back: now stars are incentivised to do their number with actual tickets. They do what manifestos cannot: cut through the hum of policyspeak, and drag voters—and cameras—to the ground level. Khesari brings the Bhojpuri battering-ram of mass recall: stage presence and ready-made rural trust. Maithili offers a gentler cultural gravitas—and cross-generational appeal. Will the script leap from marquee to mandate? Wait for the live auditions at Chhapra and Alinagar!

▼ BLAME GAME

SAMRAT STRIKES BACK



Samrat Choudhary has been quite the voodoo doll for Prashant Kishor of late—the turbaned deputy CM has all those pins dug into his past to show for it. On October 16, he hit back at a live Q&A. "*Main yahan nomination kar chuka hoon... koi bhag gaya chunav ladne se.*". Expanded, that goes: "Here I stand, publicly accused, yet I dare to face the people's court. By contrast, the accuser has vamoosed at the prospect of a contest." Dipping into cartoonish metaphor, he also likened PK to a "joker" in the political deck—the card that appears only to vanish!